

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The Deccan as a connected but frictional field

AGRA / MALWA -> mobilisation and northern imperial core

KHANDESH / BURHANPUR -> corridor, market and staging point

ASIRGARH -> fortified gateway, not automatic plateau control

BERAR / BALAGHAT -> operational foothold and contested revenue

AHMADNAGAR -> claimant, fort and hinterland can come apart

BIJAPUR / GOLCONDA -> autonomous courts, resources and southern ambitions.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Deccan chronology 1562-1657

1562-76 -> Khandesh contacts and submission | 1591 -> embassies

1595-96 -> Ahmadnagar crisis; Chand Bibi; Berar settlement

1600-01 -> Ahmadnagar fort, Balaghat, Asirgarh and Khandesh

1610 -> Malik Ambar reverses much of Akbar's gain

1616-21 -> Mughal recovery followed by Jahangir's limited policy

1633 -> Daulatabad | 1636 -> treaties | 1656-57 -> compact breached.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: A spectrum of political relations

DIPLOMACY -> recognition sought without immediate annexation

ALLIANCE -> service and negotiated cooperation

SUZERAINTY -> tribute, khutba or arbitration under retained local rule

OCCUPATION -> army controls a fort or zone without durable integration

ANNEXATION -> territorial incorporation plus administrative claim

TRAP: do not translate every hierarchy into a modern sovereignty binary.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Chand Bibi and the Ahmadnagar crisis

SUCCESSION DISPUTE -> external intervention becomes possible

CHAND BIBI -> defends, seeks allies and negotiates under factional pressure

1596 TERMS -> Bahadur recognised; Berar ceded; suzerainty accepted

RENEWED WAR -> factions and the Berar dispute erode the bargain

1600 SIEGE -> proposed negotiation is branded betrayal; Chand Bibi is killed

LESSON: constrained agency, not a romantic warrior-queen-only story.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Akbar's foothold and its limits

GAIN -> Berar, Balaghat, Ahmadnagar fort and Khandesh-Asingarh

STRATEGY -> diplomacy first, then force through succession opportunity

VALUE -> routes, prestige, revenue claims and a Deccan entry platform

LIMIT -> Bijapur and Golconda remain outside direct Mughal rule

LIMIT -> a captured fort does not secure countryside or local loyalty

VERDICT: meaningful foothold, not conquest of the whole Deccan.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Malik Ambar's resistance engine

LEGITIMACY -> Nizam Shahi claimant and Ahmadnagar state frame

LEADERSHIP -> Habshi political and military organisation

COALITION -> Maratha bargis, local chiefs and shifting Bijapur support

METHOD -> mobility, supply disruption, terrain knowledge and negotiation

FISCAL BASE -> attributed measurement and zabti-type reconstruction

LIMIT -> alliances shift; success delays but does not permanently save the state.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Why conquest did not equal consolidation

DISTANCE + SEASON -> supplies and communications become costly

FORT CAPTURE -> garrisons consume men and revenue

LOCAL INTERMEDIARIES -> information and collection require bargaining

MOBILE COALITIONS -> attack routes and avoid set-piece weakness

NOMINAL REVENUE -> differs from realised, usable surplus

LOOP: incomplete control creates resistance, cost and renewed intervention.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Jahangir: recovery with restraint

INHERITANCE -> Ambar has reversed much of Akbar's position

COMMAND PROBLEM -> rival Mughal forces struggle to coordinate

1616-17 -> Khan-i-Khanan and Prince Khurram recover ground

DIPLOMACY -> attempts to detach allies and recognise negotiated hierarchy

CHOICE -> Jahangir does not convert victory into unlimited expansion

VERDICT: limited commitment can be policy, not simple military weakness.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: The pre-Shivaji Maratha bridge

DESHMUKHS -> local revenue, armed following and territorial knowledge

BARGIS -> mobile cavalry serving changing Deccan coalitions

MALIK AMBAR -> creates opportunities, training and bargaining space

SHAHJI -> moves across Nizam Shahi, Bijapuri and Mughal service fields

RESULT -> capability and confidence grow before a mature Maratha state

BOUNDARY: do not project later nationalism or Shivaji's polity backward.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Daulatabad and the 1636 settlement

1633 -> Daulatabad falls; Nizam Shahi dynasty is extinguished

BIJAPUR -> suzerainty, indemnity, arbitration and a Shahji condition

GOLCONDA -> khutba and tribute under Mughal protection

BUFFER LOGIC -> local states retain initiative while direct costs stay lower

COERCION -> force makes the hierarchy possible; parties are not equals

VERDICT: pragmatic institutional design, not full Deccan annexation.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Campaign, treaty, tribute, elite defection and revenue logistics were linked but not interchangeable mechanisms.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Why the 1656-57 compact broke

STABLE EXPECTATION -> tribute, protection, arbitration and buffer autonomy

SOUTHERN GROWTH -> Bijapur and Golconda gain resources and confidence

MUGHAL PRESSURE -> fiscal claims, compensation and territorial demands

CRISIS -> Mir Jumla and succession disputes create intervention openings

EFFECT -> trust in the 1636 bargain weakens before the later wars

BOUNDARY: stop at 1657; do not import Aurangzeb's mature annexations.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Imperial annexation claims must be separated from durable control and from the agency of Deccani states and elites.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 18 final answer spine

OPEN -> Mughal policy evolved within a connected but costly frontier
AKBAR -> suzerainty diplomacy, selective force and an incomplete foothold
AMBAR -> coalition, mobility and local capacity expose imperial limits
JAHANGIR -> recovery joined to deliberate restraint
SHAH JAHAN -> 1633 extinction, 1636 buffers and 1656-57 breach
CLOSE -> expansion gained leverage but repeatedly outran durable control.